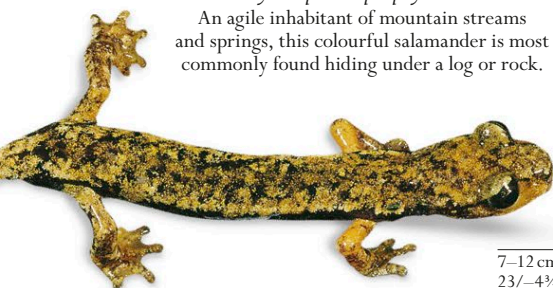




SPRING SALAMANDER
Gyrinophilus porphyriticus

An agile inhabitant of mountain streams and springs, this colourful salamander is most commonly found hiding under a log or rock.



ITALIAN CAVE SALAMANDER
Hydromantes italicus

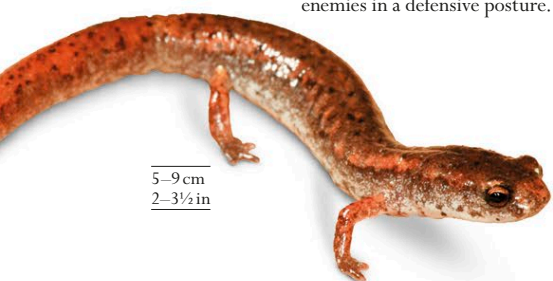
Found near streams and springs in the mountains of N. Italy, this salamander lives in caves and rock crevices.



7.5–15.5 cm
3–6 in

ENSATINA SALAMANDER
Ensatina eschscholtzii

This smooth-skinned, N. American salamander has a plump tail, which is narrow at the base. It waves its tail at enemies in a defensive posture.



5–9 cm
2–3½ in

FOUR-TOED SALAMANDER
Hemidactylium scutatum

A terrestrial salamander, the adults of this species live in mosses, but the larvae grow in water. There is a marked narrowing at the base of its tail.

ASIATIC SALAMANDERS

Around 50 small- to medium-sized species form the Hynobiidae. They are confined to Asia, with some found in mountain streams. They lay their eggs in ponds or streams, and their larvae have external gills. Some species have claws to grasp rocks.



10–16 cm
4–6½ in

OITA SALAMANDER
Hynobius dunni

Females of this endangered Japanese species produce eggs in sacs, and males then compete to fertilize them externally.

MOLE SALAMANDERS

These large creatures mostly live in burrows and emerge to forage by night. The Ambystomatidae comprises 33 species, all found in North America. Some species, notably the Mexican axolotl, are aquatic as adults and retain larval features, such as external gills.

TIGER SALAMANDER
Ambystoma tigrinum

A thick-set salamander found throughout much of N. America, this species migrates in spring to ponds to mate and lay eggs.



18–25 cm
7–10 in

yellow or white
markings on brown
or black skin

broad head
with small
eyes

MARBLLED SALAMANDER
Ambystoma opacum

This short-tailed, stocky salamander breeds in autumn and lays its eggs in dried-up ponds that fill with rain in winter.

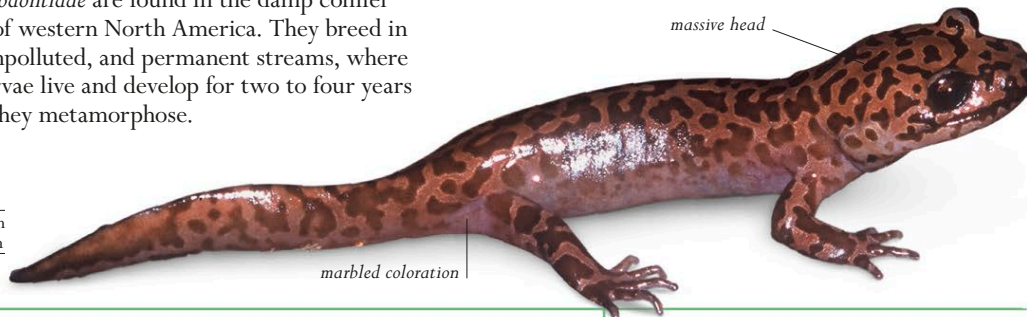


9–11 cm
3½–4¼ in

AMERICAN GIANT SALAMANDERS

The four large and aggressive species of the *Dicamptodontidae* are found in the damp conifer forests of western North America. They breed in clear, unpolluted, and permanent streams, where their larvae live and develop for two to four years before they metamorphose.

17–30 cm
6½–12 in



marbled coloration

CALIFORNIA GIANT SALAMANDER
Dicamptodon ensatus

This large, nocturnal salamander is threatened by loss and degradation of its forest habitat. This species has an aquatic larval stage.

massive head

MUDPUPPIES AND RELATIVE

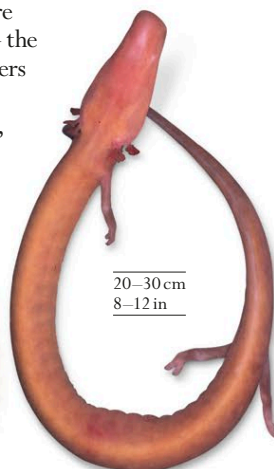
Five of the six species in the Proteidae are found in North America; the sixth one – the cave-living olm – lives in Europe. Members of this family retain the larval form into their adult life, with a long, slender body, external gills, and small eyes.



20–50 cm
8–20 in

MUDPUDDY
Necturus maculosus

A voracious predator, the mudpuppy, or waterdog, feeds on a variety of invertebrates, fish, and amphibians. The female aggressively defends her developing eggs.



20–30 cm
8–12 in

OLM
Proteus anguinus

The wholly aquatic olm lives in dark, flooded caves in Slovenia and Montenegro. It is blind and has white, pink, or grey skin.

AMPHIUMAS

Occurring in eastern North America, the Amphiumidae are a family of three large, wholly aquatic salamanders with an eel-like body and tiny limbs. Females guard the eggs in a nest on land. Amphiumas can survive drought by burrowing into mud and forming a cocoon. They feed on worms, molluscs, fish, snakes, and small amphibians.



40–110 cm
16–43 in

THREE-TOED AMPHIUMA
Amphiuma tridactylum

This large salamander, with slimy skin and a long tail, can give a painful bite. Males breed every year, while females breed in alternate years.